

Table 6.2.1 : Distribution of the Population Aged 5 Years and Over by Level of Physical and Mental Difficulties for Each Functional Domain, 2024

Functional Domains	No difficulty		Some difficulty		A lot of difficulty		Cannot do at all	
	Number	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	Number	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	Number	Rate (per 1,000 persons)	Number	Rate (per 1,000 persons)
Seeing	18,626,725	906	1,747,377	85	168,207	8	24,371	1
Hearing	19,833,909	965	602,674	29	105,760	5	24,337	1
Walking or climbing steps	18,862,616	917	1,256,095	61	369,762	18	78,207	4
Remembering or concentrating on something	19,779,068	962	619,786	30	133,641	6	34,185	2
Selfcare, such as washing all over or dressing	19,926,695	969	450,693	22	124,756	6	64,536	3
Communicating with others	20,145,867	979	308,015	15	72,412	4	40,386	2

The highest number of individuals reporting any level of difficulty ("some difficulty," "a lot of difficulty," or "cannot do at all") is observed for seeing. This means that out of every 1,000 persons aged 5 years and over, 94 individuals experience some level of difficulty in seeing. When obtaining information about vision, if a person reports no vision problems after wearing glasses, it is identified as "no difficulty".

The lowest number of individuals reporting any level of difficulty is observed for communicating with others. In other words, out of every 1,000 persons aged 5 years and over, 21 individuals experience difficulty in communication.

Table 6.2.2 presents the distribution of persons aged 5 years and over with any difficulty by district. Accordingly, 3,223,413 persons aged 5 years and over have at least one physical or mental difficulty. This corresponds to 157 persons with a physical or mental difficulty per 1,000 individuals in the population aged 5 years and over.

Considering the prevalence of at least one physical or mental difficulty, the highest rate is reported in the Hambantota district, where 183 persons per 1,000 individuals aged 5 years and over have at least one difficulty. Furthermore, Hambantota district also reports the highest rate of persons with seeing difficulties and difficulty in communication. The highest rate of persons with hearing difficulties and difficulty in remembering or concentrating is reported in the Kegalle district, while the highest rate of persons with difficulty walking or climbing steps is reported in the Kurunegala district. The highest rate of persons with difficulty performing daily activities independently is reported in the Mannar district.

Table 6.2.3 shows the distribution of people aged 5 years and over with difficulty, who reported having "some difficulty", "a lot of difficulty" or "cannot do at all" for each difficulty, by age group. The number of persons with difficulty per 1000 persons in the population of each age group is shown as its rate. Here, a significant increase is seen in the rate of persons with difficulty in seeing after the age of 45, and an increase is also seen in the rate of persons with difficulty in walking or climbing stairs after the age of 55. The population with difficulty reported in each of the considered functional domains and the rate increase with age.